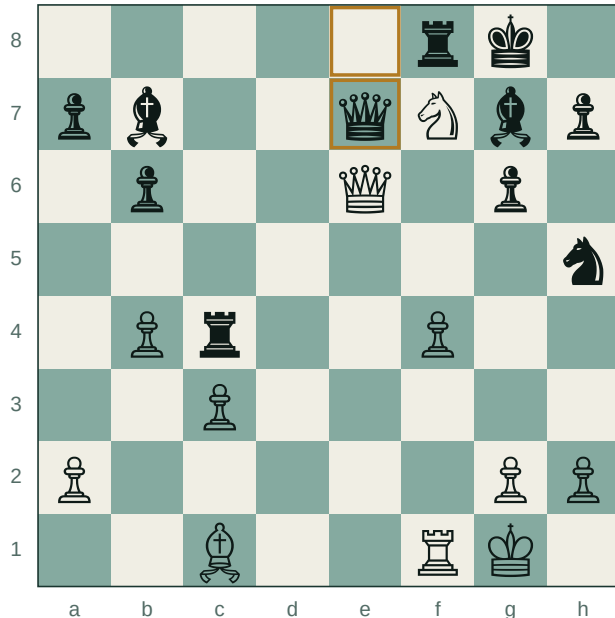


Double checks: White, move 26

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 25...Qxe7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Nh6+ Kh8 27. Qxe7

26.Nh6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the queen on e6 attacks the king on g8. Recorded reply: **26...Kh8**.

27.Qxe7 The queen captures the queen on e7. From e7 it attacks rook on f8, bishop on g7 and bishop on b7.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -6 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on e7 and rook on c4. Check for tactical protection.